THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS VIII — ENGLISH · MID-TERM PRACTICE PAPER

Session 2026–27 · Set 01

Class: VIII	Subject: English	Time: 2½ Hours	Max. Marks: 60

General Instructions:

1. The Question Paper is divided into FOUR sections. Section A: Reading 14 marks; Section B: Grammar 14 marks; Section C: Writing 12 marks; Section D: Literature 20 marks.
2. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.
3. Marks are indicated against each question.
4. Read the questions carefully before answering.

SECTION A — READING (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q1. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**

The Living Root Bridges of Meghalaya

In the rainy hills of Meghalaya, the Khasi and Jaintia people have crossed deep streams for centuries on bridges that no engineer ever built with steel or stone. These bridges are grown, not constructed. The people guide the long, strong roots of the Indian rubber fig tree across a river using bamboo scaffolding and hollowed tree trunks. Slowly, over ten to fifteen years, the roots thicken, twine together and take root on the far bank.

Unlike an iron bridge, a living bridge becomes stronger with age. Some of them are more than five hundred years old and can carry the weight of fifty people at a time. When floods damage a part of the bridge, the roots simply grow back. Villagers regard these bridges as a shared inheritance, and each generation looks after the bridges planted by its grandparents.

1. Which tree is used to grow the living root bridges? **1**

(a) Banyan tree (b) Indian rubber fig tree
(c) Bamboo tree (d) Peepal tree

2. According to the passage, why is a living bridge different from an iron bridge? **1**

(a) It is cheaper to paint (b) It becomes stronger as it gets older
(c) It is built within a week (d) It cannot carry any weight

3. How long does it take for the roots to grow across the river? **1**

(a) Two to three years (b) Five to six years
(c) Ten to fifteen years (d) More than five hundred years

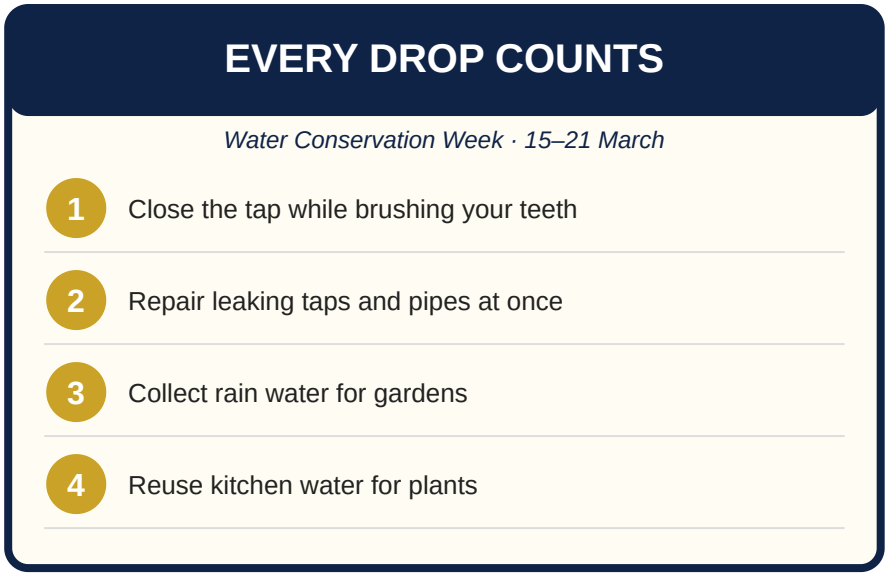
4. What happens when floods damage a part of a living bridge? **1**

(a) The bridge is abandoned (b) The roots grow back
(c) Steel rods replace it (d) A new bridge is built

5. Why do the villagers regard the living root bridges as a 'shared inheritance'? Answer in two points. **2**

6. How do the people guide the roots across the river? **1**

Q2. Study the poster carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**



India receives most of its rain in just three or four months, yet millions of families face water shortage every summer. Groundwater levels are falling because we draw water faster than nature can refill it. A single leaking tap can waste more than a thousand litres in a month. The poster issued by the school Eco Club shows that simple habits, practised by every member of a family, can save thousands of litres of water in a year.

1) According to the passage, why do many families face water shortage in summer? **1**

(a) It never rains in India (b) Most rain falls in only a few months
(c) People drink too little water (d) Rivers flow backwards

2) Which instruction on the poster would help most to stop water being wasted in a bathroom? **1**

(a) Collect rain water (b) Reuse kitchen water
(c) Close the tap while brushing (d) Plant more trees

3) A school canteen has a dripping tap. Which action is most suitable according to the poster? **1**

(a) Ignore it as it is a small leak (b) Repair it at once
(c) Cover it with a cloth (d) Use more buckets

4) The poster is most likely to be displayed in: **1**

(a) a cinema hall (b) a school corridor
(c) an airport runway (d) a bank locker room

5) How do the passage and the poster complement each other? Give two points. **2**

6) Why does the poster use numbers and short sentences? **1**

SECTION B — GRAMMAR (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q3. Do as directed.

I. Attempt any 4 from the following questions by choosing the most appropriate options. **(4x1=4)**

1) Ria was feeling cold, so she _____ her jacket before going out.

(a) took off (b) put on
(c) gave up (d) turned off

2) The doctor asked him to _____ eating junk food.

(a) give up (b) put up
(c) take after (d) look into

3) Please _____ the lights when you leave the room.

(a) turn off (b) put on
(c) give in (d) run out

4) Aman has promised to _____ his younger brother while their parents are away.

(a) look after (b) look up

(c) put off (d) take away

5) The match had to be _____ because of heavy rain.

(a) called off (b) called up

(c) called on (d) called in

II. Attempt any 4 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (4x1=4)

6) Identify the adjective that describes the bag in the sentence: *The tall boy carried a heavy bag.*

(a) tall (b) boy

(c) heavy (d) carried

7) Choose the sentence that uses the adjective correctly.

(a) This is the most easiest sum.

(b) Mount Everest is the highest peak in the world.

(c) She is more taller than me.

(d) He is the most strongest boy.

8) Adjectives are words that describe nouns and pronouns.

(State True or False.)

9) Gold is _____ than silver. *(heavier / heaviest / heavy)*

10) Rohit is the _____ student in the class.

(a) good (b) better

(c) best (d) more good

III. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (3x1=3)

11) Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb. My sister _____ (read) a book every night.

12) A verb is a word that shows an action, a state of being or possession.

(State True or False.)

13) Choose the correct verb: The children _____ in the park yesterday evening.

(a) plays (b) play

(c) played (d) playing

14) Identify the verb in the sentence: *The little bird sang sweetly in the garden.*

(a) little (b) bird

(c) sang (d) sweetly

IV. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (3x1=3)

15) Choose the correct modal verb: You _____ stop at a red signal.

(a) may (b) must

(c) might (d) could

16) Fill in the blank with a suitable modal: _____ I come in, madam?

17) Modal verbs are used to express ability, permission, possibility, advice or necessity.

(State True or False.)

18) Choose the sentence with the correct use of a modal verb.

(a) He can swims fast. (b) She must goes now.

(c) We should help the poor. (d) They may plays outside.

SECTION C — WRITING (12 Marks) — 12 marks

Q4. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) Draft a notice for the school notice board in about 50 words informing the students of classes VI–VIII about an Inter-House Quiz Competition to be held on 10 November. You are Anil/Anita, the Secretary of the Literary Club.

O R

(B) Narrate an incident when you overcame your fear and did something brave. Mention what you were afraid of, what you did, how others reacted and what you learnt, in 100–120 words.

Q5. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) You are Mohan/Mona, a resident of Rajendra Nagar, Jaipur. Write a letter to the Editor of a local newspaper in 100–120 words about the loud music played in your neighbourhood late at night, which disturbs students preparing for examinations. Suggest ways to control it.

O R

(B) You want to join a school trip to the Science Museum in Delhi. Write a letter to your Principal in 100–120 words requesting permission, mentioning the date, the purpose of the visit, the arrangements and the fee.

SECTION D — LITERATURE (20 Marks) — 20 marks

Q6. Read the following passage and answer any four out of the five questions that follow: **(4x1=4)**

Major Somnath Sharma of the 4th Kumaon Regiment was posted at Badgam, near Srinagar, in November 1947 when raiders were advancing towards the city. Although his left hand was in plaster after an injury, he insisted on leading his company. When the enemy attacked in great numbers, he ran from post to post, encouraging his men and even loading magazines for them. He fought till the last moment and was killed by a mortar shell, but his stand held up the enemy until reinforcements arrived and saved Srinagar airfield. He became the first recipient of the Param Vir Chakra.

a) Major Somnath Sharma belonged to the _____ Regiment. (4th Kumaon / Sikh Light Infantry) *(4th Kumaon / Sikh Light Infantry)*

b) Major Sharma refused to lead his company because his hand was injured.
(State True or False.)

c) What was the result of his stand at Badgam?
(a) The airfield was captured
(b) Reinforcements reached in time
(c) The raiders surrendered
(d) The company retreated

d) He was the first recipient of the:
(a) Ashoka Chakra
(b) Param Vir Chakra
(c) Vir Chakra
(d) Padma Shri

e) Why do you think Major Sharma insisted on leading despite his injury?

Q7. Read the following extract and answer any two out of the three questions that follow: **(2x2=4)**

The old clock on the village wall
Ticks softly, never late at all;
It does not boast, it does not cry,
It simply serves as hours go by.

a) What does the old clock do?

b) Pick out a word from the extract that means 'to praise oneself'.

c) What quality of the clock does the poet admire?

Q8. Answer any four out of the five questions given below. **(4x3=12)**

a) How does the story of Major Somnath Sharma continue to motivate both soldiers and ordinary citizens even today?

b) According to Verghese Kurien, how can individuals contribute to the 'common good' in their daily lives?

c) How did Tenali Ramakrishna use his wit to win the hearts of the people of Vijayanagara?

d) What does the poem 'Somebody's Mother' teach us about the behaviour of the young towards the old?

e) 'True greatness lies in service.' Support this statement with reference to any ONE lesson from Unit 2.